



Slow down aging in doggos

Researchers at the University of Washington says a new drug slows the aging process in dogs. <https://digit.in/apr22-25>



Robot learns to peel banana

Researchers developed a new ML system for a two-armed robot, allowing it to peel a banana. <https://digit.in/apr22-26>

Samsung Galaxy A53 5G

A decent mid-range phone, but not for gamers

The Galaxy A52s has been a popular mid-range phone and Samsung has rehashed it as the Galaxy A53 5G with a new 5nm Exynos 1280 chipset. How much better is the Galaxy A53 as compared to the Galaxy A52s, iQOO 9 SE or OnePlus Nord 2? Let's answer those questions.

DESIGN AND BUILD

Samsung sticks to the same design as the Galaxy A52s. Nevertheless, the Galaxy A53 is a good looking phone with simple and serene colour options. It has a polycarbonate back. The smoky matte finish feels luxurious and can resist finger grease better than most glass back phones. The Galaxy A53 is also IP67 dust and water-resistant. The phone also has stereo speakers and together they can get really loud.

DISPLAY

The Galaxy A53 has a 6.5-inch Full HD display that's advertised to go up to 800 nits bright. It is a good quality AMOLED panel with high contrast and an option for a relatively colour-accurate sRGB profile (Natural mode). The colour accuracy in the sRGB profile is excellent with an average Delta E less than 3 as measured using Spectral C6 HDR2000 Colorimeter and Calman Ultimate software.

The display constantly refreshes at 120 Hz if you choose the 'High' motion smoothness preset. This is not an HDR compliant display panel though.

PERFORMANCE

The Galaxy A53s is the first phone in India to be powered by Exynos 1280. Unfortunately, the SoC turned out to be a downgrade on benchmark platforms and in practical gaming performance.

The phone holds rather well will regular tasks like web browsing, multi-media consumption, and social media surfing, but we did encounter random stutters every now and then. Perfor-



Price
₹36,640

mance gaps begin to show when the going gets tough. In Call of Duty: Mobile, the phone defaults to 'Low' graphics and 'Very High' frame rate and even at these settings, FPS stability wasn't up to the mark.

When it comes to software, Samsung is a very solid place today. Numerous customisation options, seamless integration with Your Phone app on Windows, and Samsung Pay are some of the highlights to look forward to. Samsung has been great with software updates lately and it assures 4 major OS version upgrades for the Galaxy A53!

CAMERA

Once again Samsung continues with the same camera specs as on the Galaxy A52 and Galaxy A52s. The quartet on the rear is led by a 64MP primary sensor, 12MP ultra-wide camera, 5MP macro camera, and 5MP depth sensor.

The Galaxy A53 does quite well in proper daylight. Most consumers are likely to appreciate the pleasantly oversaturated tones. In low light, the image quality takes a hit but the Galaxy A53 still manages to perform better than expected. The camera is quite deft

with metering but over-processing adds noise. The images you'd get will still suffice for social media purposes though. The night mode helps keep the shutter open a wee-bit longer.

BATTERY LIFE

The Exynos 1280 chipset is based on a 5 nm process and proved quite power efficient. With moderate to heavy use, we could consistently manage more than one day of backup. We managed a screen on time of approximately 6.5 hours on a full charge.

The 5000 mAh battery takes around 2 hours to refill if you use a 25W USB PD charger or the thunderbolt port of your laptop. So, even if you manage to lay your hands on a fast charger, charging speeds are slower than what the competition offers.



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VERDICT

The Galaxy A53 is everything we expect of a Samsung mid-range phone. The experience is quite pacifying, mostly thanks to the palatable software and good-quality display, but it's also let down by a mediocre chipset. If you are into gaming, phones like the OnePlus 9R, OnePlus Nord 2, iQOO 9 SE or perhaps even Galaxy A52s should offer better value. Nevertheless, the A53 is an allrounder with a lot to look forward to. It has an appealing design, offers decent camera performance for the price, and assures a reliable battery backup. At the same time, the mid-range Exynos chip hampers the experience. The lack of a charging adaptor and slow charging speeds are other peeve points.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 189g | DISPLAY DIMENSIONS: 6.5-inches | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 2400x1080 | OPERATING SYSTEM: Android 12, One UI 4.1 | CPU: Exynos 1280 5nm | GPU: Mali-G68 | RAM: 6GB/8GB | STORAGE: 128GB, MicroSD Card slot | BATTERY: 5000mAh | Charging: 25W | CAMERA: 64MP + 12MP + 5MP + 5MP (Rear), 32MP (Front)

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